

100%-cotton sock.

4. Tape card to a stick to make a marker. Mark the spot.

5. Dig the sock up after eight weeks. If it's been eaten, with plenty of holes, the soil is healthy because it has lots of organisms!

Health and safety
If you have a cut or graze, cover it with a plaster before touching soil. After you've touched soil, wash your hands!

Hints and tips

- Don't use worms from a compost heap. These don't live in soil.
- Look after the worms by keeping them in dark, cool, and damp conditions. Carry them to and from the wormery in a tub lined with damp kitchen towel.

soil, sand, a pencil, a spray bottle, cardboard, leaves, and tape.

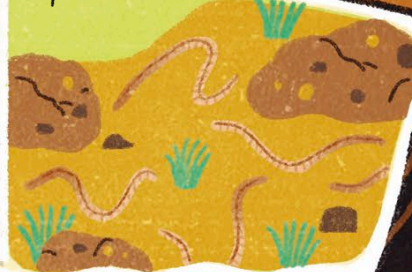
4. Worms like the dark! Wrap cardboard around the wormery to block out light. Spray the hotel with water daily.



5. After a week, see how the worms have changed the soil. There will be lots of burrows, the layers will have begun to disappear, and the leaves may have been dragged into the soil.



6. Release the worms back into their original home after your week's experiment.



a watering can, a rake, carrot seeds, newspaper, plant labels, and a shop-bought carrot.

4. Water the carrots often but gently, at ground level.



5. When the plants are around 10 cm (4 in) tall, thin them to one plant every 6 cm (2 in) by pulling out the smaller ones.



6. After 16–20 weeks your carrots should be fully grown! Gently pull them out of the ground.



7. Compare the carrots to a shop-bought one to see the difference!

